

Westhampton Finance Committee Meeting
October 6, 2015

Meeting opened at 7:05 PM

Present: Chair, Ellice Gonzalez, Celeste Whiting, Chevy Seney, Jackie Brodeur, Joe Pipczynski, Aniko Giordano, Mary Cleary and Anna Eleanor, Mary Ann Duggan arrived at 7:10pm. Also present was Selectman Phil Dowling

Motion to accept minutes of September 15, 2015, approved 7-0

Chairperson Ellice presented on Finance Committee Association meeting. She also asked for volunteers to set up chairs at the finance workshop at the library on October 8, 2015.

Committee looked at samples of recommendation forms from the Board of Selectmen (SB) and chose sample #2. This form to be used in the future by the Finance Committee (FC) when considering articles for a town meeting.

Article #1: Discussion of what the actual cost of the tanker truck will be and what the grant will fund. There was some confusion as to what amount should be voted on and how the article should read. Ellice asked to remove the language (actual cost of the truck) from the article and vote on the remainder of the article. Chevy Seney made a motion to accept Article 1 funding the difference between the grant and the actual cost of the tanker truck, but with the last sentence deleted. Seconded by Mary Cleary. Voted 7 yes, 0 no, 1 abstain.

Article #2: Mary Cleary made a motion to approve Article 2 which rescinds the vote taken at Annual Town meeting to appropriate \$30,000 for the Tanker Truck; seconded by Maryann Duggan. Voted 8 yes, 0 no, 0 abstention

Article #3: Aniko Giordano made a motion to accept motion to return funds (\$3,498) to the Reserve Fund, seconded by Mary Cleary. Voted 8 yes, 0 no, 0 abstention.

Meeting scheduled with SB and FC on October 20, 2015 to discuss Special Town Meeting (STM) process. Ellice shared information on time line required by by-law 5-3-7 for receiving articles from the SB to FC. Explained that SB and FC should be in agreement with procedures and recommendations. Further stated that FC should be voting on SB signed articles not proposed articles.

Ellice suggested a joint SB/FC meeting on articles should occur at times other than regularly scheduled SB meetings because of insufficient time at regular SB meetings.

At the next meeting Oct. 20, with the SB, Ellice recommended that the following be discussed:

- 1) Can SB change language on articles after FC votes them?
- 2) Capital Planning Committee

Ellice mentioned that many different qualifications exist in the members of the FC. Celeste Whiting suggested that each member give a quick blurb on their distinct qualifications for the rest of the members.

Set next meeting on October 20, 2015 at 7pm.

Meeting adjourned 8:40pm

Respectfully submitted
Joseph I Pipczynski